

ENG 101

LESSON 16

TONE Look at the five statements expressing different attitudes about a 'shabby house.' Label each statement by choosing the most appropriate tone from the word bank.

optimistic	bitter	tolerant
sentimental	humorous	sympathetic

1. This may be a shabby, run-down looking house, but since I lived here in my childhood it has a special place in my heart. (sentimental)
2. This may not be the best looking house in the neighborhood, but it's not really that bad. (tolerant)
3. If only I had a decent job, I wouldn't be reduced to living in this ramshackle dump. (bitter)
4. This place is in need of some costly renovation, and I expect the landlord to get around to them any day now. (optimistic)
5. When I leave this joint, I plan to empty rubbish bins of all the neighboring flats into it so I can leave the place exactly as I found it. (humorous)

Now you will look at three short passages each of which illustrates a tone given in the box. Remember the tone reflects the author's attitude. To find the tone of a paragraph, ask yourself what attitude is revealed by its words and phrases.

caring	pessimistic	objective
optimistic	angry	critical

